

Topic 4 – Communications and networks

Students should:		Curriculum reference
4.1	Understand the online services offered by shopping sites (basket, checkout, secure payment, product catalogue), entertainment providers (streaming, downloading), gaming sites	CN2.1E
4.2	Know that digital devices can communicate with each other by transferring data that can be sent wirelessly or through a wired network	CN5.1B
4.3	Understand different forms of cyberattack that use social engineering (shoulder surfing, phishing, pharming)	CN2.1A, CN5.2B

Students should:		Curriculum reference
4.5	Understand why computers are connected in a network, including the Internet (World Wide Web, video sharing, telephone services)	CN5.1A
4.6	Know about different methods that are available to secure data and personal information online (username, password, PIN, biometrics)	CN5.2A
4.7	Understand the impact of networks on information services, learning, entertainment and leisure	CN6.1A
4.8	Understand the social impacts of the use of networks (social interaction, cyberbullying, physical activity)	CN6.2A
4.9	Know the meaning of the term 'digital etiquette' and how to behave safely, responsibly and with regard to others when using digital technologies	CN6.2D
4.10	Understand what constitutes acceptable/unacceptable online behaviour and to report concerns about content, contact and conduct to an appropriate individual or organisation	CN6.2D
4.11	Understand key features of online communities (social networking, online gaming, online work spaces, virtual learning environments (VLEs), user-generated reference sites (wikis, websites, forums), user-generated content (video sharing sites, blogs, websites, social bookmarking))	CN6.2A
4.12	Understand how copyright legislation affects the use of digital information and media	CN4.2A
4.13	Understand the health and safety issues that arise from individuals' use of digital devices (neck strain, eye strain, wrist strain, RSI, sedentary lifestyle) and know how they can be minimised (taking breaks, positioning of equipment, exercising, lighting, adjusting text size, adjusting contrast)	CN6.2F
4.14	Know how to use search engines and bookmarks effectively	CN4.3A
4.15	Be able to evaluate the fitness for purpose of available information in terms of accuracy, age, relevance, reliability, bias	CN4.3B